

Motivated by Our Kids

Millionaires are also motivated by what they learned from their parents and what they hope to pass on to their children. Our study found that 86% of millionaires learned the importance of saving and taking control of their money from their parents. Those parents knew how to save money, too. In fact, 85% of millionaires describe their parents as savers—and of those, 13% said their parents were “extreme savers.” That living example made an impact on the next generation, as those savers’ children grew up to be millionaires. This clearly shows that parents have the power to fight back against the destructive messages their kids hear from other people and to replace those messages with encouragement and hope. If you want your children to grow up to become millionaires (not counting the millions you may leave them one day), then you need to model millionaire behaviors for them. It’s like my friend Rachel Cruze always says, “More is caught than taught.” Your kids will learn how to handle money by watching you. Those healthy (or unhealthy) behaviors are passed down from generation to generation. If your parents didn’t model healthy millionaire habits for you, you can be the one to turn things around in your family tree. Even if you don’t leave your children a pile of money when you die, you *can* leave them the attitudes and attributes that will enable them to reach millionaire status for themselves.

This point was driven home to me as I was writing this. I had received an email from Cindy, a lady I had met several years ago at a speaking engagement in North Carolina. She and her husband, James, had good incomes, but they weren’t being intentional about what they were doing. By attending the event I led, they learned the basic principles of wealth building and put those principles to work immediately. They stopped excusing their own financial laziness and took ownership of their finances. As they got their act together, they involved their children and passed down what they were learning about money. Cindy had emailed me to let me